

Blest be the tie that binds

Text: John Fawcett, 1782, alt.

Music: Johann G. Nägeli, 1828; arr. Lowell Mason, 1845

DENNIS SM

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. It is in the key of D major (indicated by two sharps) and 3/4 time. The score consists of two systems of music. The first system contains the first four lines of the hymn, and the second system contains the final four lines. Each line of music is accompanied by a set of lyrics. Above the vocal staves, chord symbols (E, B7, A, E7, B, B7, E, A/E, E, A, E/B, B7, E) are placed to indicate the harmonic structure. The piano accompaniment is written in the bass clef, providing a steady harmonic foundation for the voices.

1 Blest be the tie that binds our hearts in Chris - tian love.
2 We share each oth - er's woes, each oth - er's bur - dens bear,
3 When we a - sun - der part, it gives us in - ward pain,
4 From sor - row, toil, and pain, and sin we shall be free,

The fel - low - ship of kin - dred minds is like to that a - bove.
and of - ten for each oth - er flows the sym - pa - thiz - ing tear.
but we shall still be joined in heart, and hope to meet a - gain.
and per - fect love and friend-ship reign through all e - ter - ni - ty.